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2026 Robot Vacuum Guide: Roomba vs Shark – Best Pick

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Feeling overwhelmed by the flood of robot-vacuum options in 2026? You’re not alone—new models drop every month, suction specs shift, and convenience features like self-empty docks come with a price tag that can make you second-guess every click.

We cut through the noise. By laying out the specs, real-world owner feedback, and the exact trade-offs between the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without its AutoEmpty Dock) and the Shark AI Ultra, we give you the confidence to pick a machine that truly matches your home and your budget.

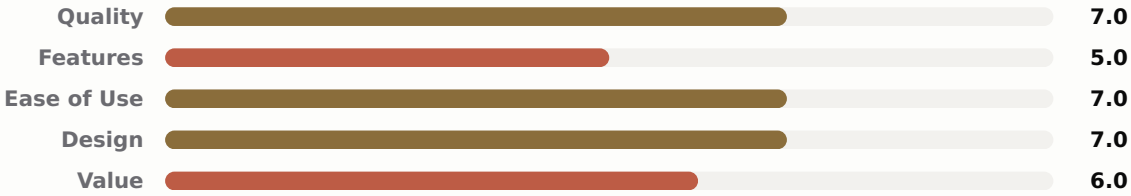
Read on for a clear, side-by-side comparison, see where each model shines, and follow our simple recommendation to the best deal—complete with trusted affiliate links that help keep this guide free.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

At a Glance: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo vs. Shark AI Ultra



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Product	Price (Oct 4 2026)	Rating	Reviews	Key Features	Best For
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99	4.4 ★	5,217	Vacuum + mop, AutoEmpty dock, 3-stage cleaning, Imprint Smart Mapping	Hands-free cleaning, pet-hair, mixed-floor homes
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)	$139.99	4.4 ★	5,217	Vacuum + mop, Imprint Smart Mapping, compatible with optional dock	Budget buyers who don’t mind emptying the bin manually
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	4.0 ★	23,990	AI Laser Navigation, self-cleaning brushroll, 30-day capacity bagless base, SharkClean app	Large homes, deep carpet cleaning, users who prefer bagless base

Cleaning Performance: Suction & Navigation

Suction power – Owner feedback consistently rates the Shark AI Ultra's suction as "strong" on carpets, thanks to its self-cleaning brushroll that stops hair wrap. The Roomba 115X uses a 3-stage system with rubber brushes that excel on hard floors and low-pile carpet but may need more frequent bin emptying in pet-heavy households.

Navigation intelligence – Roomba's Imprint Smart Mapping builds a persistent floor plan you can edit room-by-room in the iRobot app, enabling selective room cleaning and no-go zones. Shark's AI Laser Navigation scans the space in real time, adjusting to furniture moves, but it doesn't store a map you can tweak.

Which Model Fits Your Lifestyle?

- **Choose the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** if you want true hands-free operation, have pets, and value the convenience of a self-emptying base that holds up to 60 days of debris.
- **Choose the Roomba 115X Combo without dock** if you're watching the budget, don't mind emptying the bin after each run, and still want solid vacuum-and-mop performance on mixed floors.
- **Choose the Shark AI Ultra** if you have a large home with thick carpets, prefer a bagless base that lasts 30 days, and appreciate AI laser navigation that adapts on the fly.

Ready to Buy? Here Are the Best Current Offers

All links are affiliate-supported; purchasing through them helps keep this guide free and up-to-date.

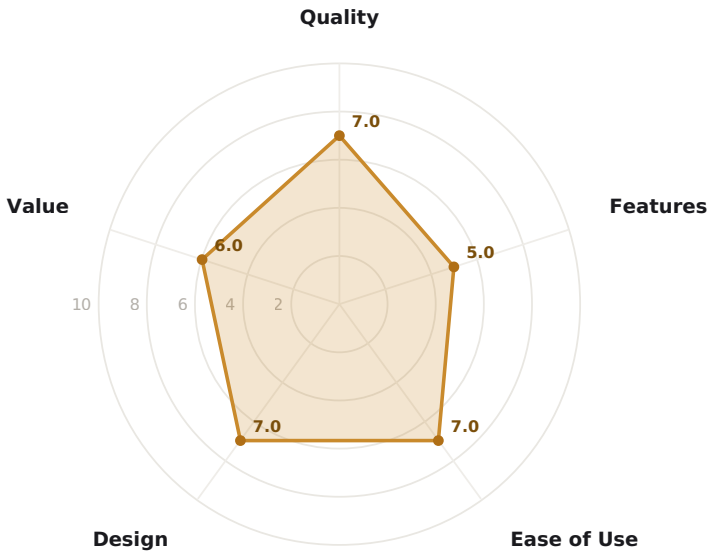
- iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – $199.99
- iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – $139.99
- Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum – $249.99

Pick the model that matches your needs, click the link, and enjoy cleaner floors with less effort.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.